

DEAN HANSON

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Translatables

During my time grinding HVAC engineering projects in the AEC industry, I have logged the challenges I have overcome and thus skills I have built that span any industry and any role.

From being thrown into the Blue Origin wolf den right out of college in 2019, to juggling four critical projects as the team lead in 2025 serving Boeing, Lockheed Martin, and CCSFS simultaneously (full-remote and also hybrid), it seems I've carved out an impressive HVAC AEC portfolio.

I love life. My greatest weakness is my fascination for many facets of life and work. That has led me to working every weekend and many moonlight hours during the week. Each day alive (and more importantly thriving) on Earth is a true blessing from God. Each day, I instill that in my mind and soul through visceral meditation and prayer. I am far from perfect, however the more light I take in, the more I can shine.

As I reflect on my work life through unique Questercising, this document is a catalyst for any career change that aligns best with my inherent abilities, acquired abilities, and my current ikigai on Earth.

Solar Sales and Chief Operating Office

Warmac Energy

August 2024 – February 2025, FL, NJ, PA, DE

- Built real sales toughness through sustained rejection — perseverance after being humbled, insulted, condescended. This rejection is critical to growth, and strengthened composure across business, creativity, and life (piel dura).
- Developed into a highly competent salesman: storyteller, conversational weaver, and steerer — able to guide dialogue toward trust, clarity, and decisive action.
- Enhanced internal operations through hands-on system building: onboarding processes, training frameworks, templates, and repeatable workflows. Trained and onboarded team members with a focus on clarity, accountability, and ownership.
- Ran a business with a partner — learning firsthand how leadership, trust, incentives, and pressure evolve under both scarcity and growth. Practiced radical accountability — commitments made were commitments delivered. Led with emotional intelligence — conveying direction, sentiment, and hard truths with intention rather than noise.
- Gained exposure to the solar energy industry and its end-to-end flows, building transferable intuition for industries with complex permitting, financing, logistics, and customer-education cycles.
- Worked two demanding jobs simultaneously, absorbing overtime, sacrifice, and sustained discomfort to keep operations moving.

Stage Performer

Deansy: music, comedy, motivation, poetry, spoken word

May 2022 – Death; FL, NY, NJ, PA

- Weekly stage performances yield a unique stack of identities that no other endeavor does; this venture eliminates social anxiety and builds calm, controlled presence under pressure. After years, the evolved states become part of your walking identity.
- Developed the ability to speak clearly, directly, and **without fear** in front of rooms, cameras, and critical audiences. I have seen (lived) this directly translate to critical client presentations with large audiences in my HVAC AEC career.
- Built instinct for timing, pacing, and emotional calibration — knowing when to push, pause, or pivot in live environments. Became physically looser and more expressive on stage, translating **confidence** into movement, delivery, and command.
- Comfortable being seen, evaluated, and judged — and continuing forward without shrinking. I have an audience of one – that would be God. I am simply flesh, and pray to **relinquish** my mind and flesh each day to **distill my ego** and align myself with my purpose on Planet Earth.

- Experience performing in unpredictable, high-energy settings where **adaptability** matters more than perfection. Adapting to audiences is critical awareness. Understanding the concept of “**reception spectrum**” goes hand in hand with the process!

Human X-factors

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Daily – Death; Earth & beyond

- Operates in discomfort by choice — using friction as training rather than avoiding it. Building resilience daily through exposure to fear, rejection, uncertainty, and pressure. My daily resistance practice combines deep meditation, intense physical training, prayer, and deliberate heat/cold exposure to build clarity, emotional regulation, and stress tolerance. This practice maintains clarity in both solitude and chaos.
- Disciplined addiction and mental cleanses including unique phone fasting (writing a pocketbook about this), 50+ minute sauna sessions emulating Yucatan Temazcal ceremonies, oxygen-deprivation mask stairclimber sessions 110 floors (World Trade Center)
- I practice Spanish daily as a cognitive training tool and to build long-term cross-cultural fluency.
- Able to bring people together across backgrounds and temperaments, injecting clarity, humor, and grounded energy. I am a unique leader and communicator, injecting jokes, motivation and wisdom into daily work leading to healthy work relationships. Plenty experience navigating feedback from people whose opinions carry emotional weight, without losing self-trust. Known for elevating morale, steadiness, and focus within groups simply by how I show up.
- As an artist that aspires to grow my supporters and share my creations for the benevolence of the people, this has led to wearing unique hats. I lead a team consisting of audio engineer and producer partners, a video editor in Lima, Peru for almost two years compounding our chemistry, and as of late 2025 have been working with a scheduler and analytics gentlemen I met at a concert in Philadelphia. Throughout the years since February 2022, I have persevered through immense heartbreak seeing my dreams shine and crumble over 100 times. There is something deep in me, planted in my youth competing in ice hockey and football, to never give up. To choose to fight and persevere.

AEC Industry_HVAC engineer_black sheepwolf

BRPH

December 2023 – Present; Florida & beyond

This section emphasizes translatable skills from AEC logged over the years since my true evolution catalyzed. These are the notable translatables from my AEC job that carry with me to other industries and endeavors.

- **Navigated dysfunctional dynamics directly:** absentee project managers, contradictory SOWs vs DRFI responses, and clients who changed direction midstream — without losing delivery momentum.
- Developed a **strong radar for proactivity:** asking the questions that prevent downstream pain (future tenant upsizing, fuel selection, partial demo vs reuse, sequencing for future flexibility).
- Reads, filters, and synthesizes **critical massive documents** — SOWs, RFPs, specs, and contracts — extracting what’s accurate, relevant, and actionable while discarding noise.
- In 2023, learned to **lead projects independently** on federal and aerospace work, owning outcomes amid constant scope shifts, contradictions, and pressure. No one else my age had this level of responsibility.
- Learned to “**eat an elephant**” on a Patrick Space Force Base project including large-scale systems: 13 AHUs/MAUs, a cooling tower, CHW with WCC, multiple variable primary pumping systems, refrigerant monitoring, and full hydronic and airflow control architectures — sequencing one system at a time until the whole project was complete.

- **Independently** authored extensive specifications and control documents by teaching myself through manufacturer reps, manuals, and deep technical study when no playbook existed, and no senior mentor was there for me.
- Conducted site walks, client meetings, and proposal efforts — including LCCAs (Life Cycle Cost Analysis) and early studies — to **secure future work and influence project direction** upstream.
- **Technically writes** design narratives, bid books, proposals, and specifications with brevity and intent.
- **Built** internal SOPs and automation **systems**: selection email templates, GPT-friendly Excel tools, and workflows where combined PDFs feed schedules directly into deliverables.
- **Uses GPT intentionally** for learning and acceleration: cooling tower bypass logic, UFGS specs, sequence comprehension — not as a crutch, but as a force multiplier.
- Aggressively and unapologetically protects **focus and momentum** through deep, sedentary work — works in sprints, closes external communication, and minimizes attention residue.
- Leads client meetings and internal teams with a balance of firmness and tact — the “ginger dance” of human and client interactions.
- **Thinks in 3D while reading 2D** — visualizing buildings, systems, and constraints inside BIM and selection software.
- Navigates a wide spectrum of personalities — including egos, volatility, and miserable behavior — while still delivering clean outcomes.
- Resolves hard surprises without stopping parallel deadlines.
 - Example: resolved a late-stage refrigerant change (R-410A → R-454B) on an aging project by diving into ASHRAE 15, IMC, consulting peers, running calcs, coordinating with Trane, and closing a high-risk field RFI decisively.
- Skilled at **making complicated topics simple** for non-technical decision-makers — enabling confident, high-cost choices.
- Capable of sound decisions across varying levels of certainty; knows **when to double down**, delegate, or deliberately strengthen a weakness.
- Experienced working as the youngest person in high-stakes rooms — often without assistants or backup — carrying disproportionate responsibility.
- Built the muscle of anticipating change, accepting iteration (11+ revisions on Pod 6; constant iteration on SpaceX), and logging scope drift instead of resisting it.
- Moves forward without full information while clearly communicating schedule, cost, and lead-time consequences.

Profitable Poker Player

Atlantic City, NJ + Florida

July 2019 - December 2021

- Poker (against other humans not the house) has exceptional parallels for life: moving forward with uncertainty (sometimes in an instant), objectively assessing fortunate/misfortunate events despite correct/incorrect decisions, handling seemingly colossal misfortune and learning forward, learning humans within the first 10 seconds and 10 minutes of exposure and information ingestion.
- True accountability with poker partners and an excel sheet tracking hours and profit.

Principles and Interests

- Prioritizes consistent relationship maintenance, regularly calling family and close friends to keep trust, perspective, and grounding intact. Through this, I have maintained relationships for over 10 years despite leaving home in July 2019.
- Follows a disciplined, long-term investing philosophy (similar to Bogleheads) focused on low-cost indexing, risk management, and compounding over speculation.
- I study and invest in Web3 systems with a focus on incentives, governance, and decentralized infrastructure rather than hype cycles.
- I actively study modern homesteading, permaculture, and sustainable system design as extensions of systems thinking applied beyond the screen.

SOFTWARE COMPETENCY

- Software developer tools: VS Code, LLMs, Git, HTML, CSS, Javascript implementation (learning with AI not blind vibe coding), leveraging GPT wisely for research, markdowns, coding
- Folder architecture, markdown file design, GPT training
- AEC building design tools: Autodesk Revit, Bluebeam Revu, Trane Trace 700 & 3D
- FL Studio for tracking, mixing, project collaboration, light production, light mastering
- Capcut desktop video editing for simple yet effective creative videos